

Ki Seitzei LaMilchamah

Maamor — free translation & elucidation (brief synopsis) · Shabbos Parshas Ki Seitzei, Elul 5725 · bilti-mugah

⌘ MAAMOR

כִּי־ (Devorim 21:10) The Possuk:
תֵּצֵא לַמִּלְחָמָה עַל־אֹיְבֶיךָ
וְנָתַנּוּהָ אֵל קִיָּךְ בְּיָדְךָ וְשָׁב
בִּיתְּךָ

CONCEPT

If you go out to war upon your enemies, and HaShem, your Gd, will deliver him into your hands, and you shall take his captives” Rashi states on the words ‘If you go out to war’: The verse here is referring to an optional war i.e., non-obligatory (Sifrei 21:1), since in reference to the obligatory war to conquer the land of Eretz Yisroel, it would be inappropriate to say “you shall take his captives” because it has already been stated regarding the seven nations of Canaan, “from these peoples’ cities... you shall not allow any soul to live.” (Devorim 20: 16).

Alter Rebbe: Rabbi Shneur Zalman of Liadi, founder and first Rebbe of Chabad, 1745-1813. Author of Shulchan Oruch HoRav, and the Tanya. Delivered Maamorim that were then published in Likkutei Torah, Torah Or and Maamarei Admur Hazaken.

The Parsha begins with the Possuk

כִּי־ תֵצֵא לַמִּלְחָמָה עַל־אֹיְבֶיךָ

If you go to war upon your enemies”.

The Alter Rebbe explains in Likkutei Torah(this is further explained in the Maamorim of the Miteller Rebbe and

Likkutei Torah: The work was published originally in two parts. The first part, Torah Or, was first

Alter Rebbe, and transcribed by the Alter Rebbe's brother amongst others, most of them from 5556 (1796) through the end of 5572 (1812), covering the books of Bereishis and Shmos, with several Maamorim on Shavuot and Pesach. The second half was published in Zhitomir in 5608 (1848) under the title Likkutei Torah, with Maamorim covering the books of Vayikra, Bamidbar and Devorim, Shir Hashirim, Yomim Tovim, Rosh Hashana & Yom Kipur. This is further explained: In the Maamorim of the Mitteler Rebbe (second Chabad Rebbe, R' Dov Ber, son and successor to the Alter Rebbe) as well as the Maamorim of the Tzemach Tzedek (Third Chabad Rebbe, R' Menachem Mendel, grandson of the Alter Rebbe) and his commentary on the Alter Rebbe's Maamorim and in the Maamorim of the later Chabad Rebbeim (the fourth Rebbe was his son R' Shmuel the Rebbe Maharash, followed by the fifth Rebbe his son R' Sholom Dovber the Rebbe Rashab followed by the

of the Tzemach Tzedek and of the Rebbeim that succeeded) that it is brought down in the Zohar that the time of prayer is a time of battle. The Alter Rebbe also brings the Targum translation on the words of the Possuk

אשר לקחתי מידה אורי בחיורי " ובקשתי

which I took from the hand of the Amorite with my sword and with my bow."

CONCEPT

Targum: Onkelos was a member of the Roman royal family. His mother was Hadrian's sister and his father was called Klonikas. He converted to Judaism. He became a disciple of Rabbi Eliezer ben Horkanos and Rabbi Yehoshua ben Chananya, the great Tannaim who were disciples of Rabbi Yochannan ben Zakkai. Onkelos translated the Torah into Aramaic, according to the explanations handed down from generation to generation, through Ezra the Scribe and back to Moshe. This is our Targum Onkelos!

sixth Rebbe his son the Friediker Rebbe the Rebbe Rayatz).

לך שכם אחד על־אחיך אשר לקחתי מיד "האורי בחיורי ובקשתי

And I have given you one portion over your brothers, which I took from the hand of the Amorite with my sword and with my bow."

The basic explanation of these words is as Rashi states in one of his explanations: “Since you are taking the trouble to occupy yourself with my burial, I have given you an inheritance where you will be buried”. And which is this? This is Shechem which: Simeon and Levi slew the men of Shechem with my sword and with my bow, all those nations around Yaakov’s sons assembled to attack them, and Yaakov girded weapons of war against them. — [from Bereishis Rabbah 97:6, Targum Yonosson ben Uzziel].

The Targum substitutes the words my sword and my bow for: “

ב צלו תי ו ב בעו תי

my prayer and my supplications”.

In other words, when our Possuk states

כִּי־תִצֵּא לִמְלַחְמָה

it refers to the battle which is the ‘Avoda’

CONCEPT

Prayers and supplications: The full Targum of the Possuk is ו א נא י ה בית לך חו לך חד י תיר I give you one portion more than your brothers which I took from the hands of the Emorites with my prayer and my supplications. The Seforno says on the words: ב ח כ מ תי ו ב י נ this means נ ב ח כ מ תי with my wisdom and with my understanding which are the swords and bows of the Tzaddikim as the Possuk states: (Tehilim 45:4) חגור־ ח ר בך על־י רך גבור “הו דך ו ה דר

of prayer. The Alter Rebbe goes on to explain the continuation of the Possuk that when the Possuk states ()

כִּי־תִצֵּא לִמְלַחְמָה

(“על־א י בוך If you shall go to war) upon your enemies”

it majesty and that is your glory). Our sages in (Shabbos 63a) already commented on this verse that the Psalmist does not refer to actual weapons but to the use of words of Torah as being the tools used by the Torah scholar. That the weapons of a Tzaddik are his Chochmah and Binah. Rav Hirsch says “with my sword and bow”, which - in contrast to Esav’s sword - is my weapon, my spiritual force and my spiritual work. The bow is the weapon that works at long range, the prayers shoot up to heaven from the Earth. The sword is the weapon at close range,

the supplication, approaching Hashem in person with his entreaties or as Rav Hirsch says, his spiritual work or performing Mitzvos.

Their root: From where they stem.

Root above: where they are not enemies. As they only become enemies down here below, so it is not hard to be above them as in their source they are friendly.

CONCEPT

Nothing negative comes down from heaven: HaShem Himself is the essence of good and everything comes from Him, so at source, everything is good. The evil is only down here in this world and 'passion' and 'desire' for worldly things are tools used by the enemy - the evil inclination to distract one from serving HaShem. To understand the Alter Rebbe brings down a parable from the Zohar: A king hires a harlot to seduce his

means when you will go out to battle, to win over and cool off one's faculty of desire, from its focus on worldly material pleasures, to transform it as a love for HaShem. Then it shall be with the attitude that you are dealing "על־אִי בִיךְ" upon your enemies" from on top of your enemies i.e. at their root above because there is nothing negative that comes down from heaven, for their root א' is good, as it stems from HaShem's supernal son, so that the prince will reveal his wisdom in resisting her wiles. The harlot herself, knowing the king's intention, does not want the prince to submit to temptation. Similarly, with the Sitra Achra: it is merely fulfilling its G-d-given task in attempting to lure a person away from HaShem, but actually desires that the person resist it, thereby earning a greater reward. In any event, from this parable we see that the enemy is only operating in this realm but at source the enemy is truly a friend. א' Their root: The root of the faculty of passion and desire. Which is the root of the animal soul.

chariot ג' of holiness. ג' The Alter Rebbe continues to explain ד' that upon your enemy means above your enemy. Because in the realm above the enemy has no authority or hold whatsoever. ו' BEIS We need to understand how the Alter Rebbe's explanation ז' aligns with what Rashi says, that our Possuk "א

כִּי־תֵצֵא לִמְלַחְמָה

If you go out to war upon your enemies"

refers to an optional battle (as opposed to an obligatory battle). Rashi substantiates his interpretation that this Possuk is ^גSupernal chariot: As described by the Prophet Yechezkel (1:1-28) This chariot is HaShem's holy throne as depicted in Yechezkel's description of his vision of the angels bearing the Divine throne the face of a man, and the face of a lion on its right...and the face of an ox on the left...and the face of an eagle. This being the source and root for all of the animal kingdom and for the animal soul within us. ^גChariot of holiness: And at that point they are not enemies. ^דContinues to explain: An additional explanation that in this war on the faculty of desire the person is on top of his enemy. ^{טו}Whatever: And they have no dominion over a person, but the person dominates them. ^{טז}Explanation: That the Possuk of going out to war refers to prayer which is obligatory.

talking about a permitted battle from the words at the end of this Possuk “

ו ש ב י ת ש ב י

^{יז}Instructing: in the Possuk (Devorim 20:16)

רק מ ע ר י ה ע מ ים ה א ל ה א ש ר ה' א ל ק יך נ ת נ לך נ ח ל ה ל א ת ח י ה כ ל - “ נ ש

מ ה

However, of these peoples' cities, which HaShem, your G-d, gives you as an inheritance, you shall not allow any soul to live”

^חLiteral translation of the Torah: From its basic meaning. Although the Torah is multi-faceted and multi-dimensional, with an array of perspectives of how to understand and interpret the text, primarily through PARDES, the four modes of exegesis. This comprises ^פ‘Peshat’ - the basic, straightforward interpretation of the text, ^{ר מ}‘Remez’ - hints or the deep, allegoric, hidden or symbolic meaning beyond just the literal sense, ^{ד ר ש}‘Drush’ - to inquire or seek, the comparative MidRaShic meaning, as given through similar occurrences, and ^{ס ד}‘Sod’ secret or mystery, the esoteric mystical meaning, as given through inspiration or revelation. Nevertheless, the basic simple straightforward interpretation will always be the immediate explanation of the verse. And even from the basic meaning it can be understood to also be referring to an obligatory battle.

ל ז כ ו ת א י ל נ ה ר פ א י ל ה ב ת ש ר ה ל ר פ ו א ה ש ל י מ ה ו ק ר ו ב ה

understood not just to refer to an optional battle but also to refer to an obligatory battle. In other words this Possuk is not only coming to instruct the law of “

You shall take captives”

at the end of the Possuk, but also to teach you that when going out to any kind of war it must be with the triumphant attitude ו' that one is above the enemy, and as a result of this you will be triumphant at battle. This is akin to what the Torah writes א' in last week's ו' Triumphant attitude: As in the cliché 'A winner does not always win but always maintains a winning attitude'. This is akin: Similarly we see a similar point how even though in Parshas Shoftim the Torah is referring to an optional war (as can be seen clearly that the Kohen sends home those who have built a new home or planted a new vineyard or recently got married where if this was an obligatory battle they would have to stay and fight), yet the Torah tells us to consider the whole enemy as just one horse as it is from HaShem's perspective and therefore don't be scared similar to our Possuk whose message is; 'you are better, stronger, greater than your enemy'. א' Torah Writes: (Devorim 20:1)

כִּי־תֵצֵא לִמְלַחְמָה עַל־אִי בְךָ וְרַאי תִּסּוּ וְרַב עִם רַב מִמֶּךָ לֹא תִירָא מֵהֶם
כִּי־הָאֵל קִיךָ עִמָּךְ “ ה מ ע לֶךְ מ א רֶץ מ צ ר ים

When you go out to war against your enemies, and you see horse and chariot, a people more numerous than you, you shall not be afraid of them, for HaShem, your G-d is with you Who brought you up out of the land of Egypt”

and Rashi states: on the words horse and chariot: In My eyes, they are all like one horse. Similarly, it says,

Parsha:

כִּי־תֵצֵא לִמְלַחְמָה עַל־אִי בְךָ גּוֹי וְרַאי תִּסּוּ וְרַב עִם רַב “ מ מֶךָ לֹא תִירָא
מֵהֶם גּוֹ

When you go out to war against your enemies, and you see horse and chariot, a people more numerous than you, you shall not be afraid of them”.

. The message of this Possuk is the instruction that you shall not fear them. Since in HaShem's eyes they are all like one horse, which is consistent with what Rashi explains why the words horse and chariot are written in the singular form. Similarly, we can explain our Possuk of

“If you go out to war upon your enemies”

that the instruction to go out to war ‘upon’ your enemy means to view the [essence of the] enemy as it is in its root and “and you shall strike Midian as one man.” (Jud. 6:16) And similarly, it says, “When Pharaoh’s horse... came [into the sea]” (Exod. 15:19). - [Sifrei] a people more numerous than you: In your eyes, they are numerous, but in My eyes, they are not numerous. — [Sifrei] Dedicated in the merit of

מֵרַת רַעְכִּיל צִפְרָה בַּת מִלְכָּה שֶׁתַּחֲיִי

for a complete & speedy recovery Page 10

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source. כב As a result of which the fear will dissipate, and it will become easier to be triumphant. This principle is true with regards to an obligatory war as it is true with regards to an optional war and therefore it is also true with regards to the spiritual battle of the Avodah of prayer. However, because the end of the Possuk states

וְשָׁבִיתָ “ש ביו

You shall take captives”

יד It therefore also changes the basic translation of the words at the beginning of כב Root and source: As Rashi writes on the words of the Possuk

וְרָאִיתָ “סוס ור כב גו

And you see horse and chariot”

” that it refers to the enemy as they are in the eyes of HaShem. Similarly, over here one is to view the enemy through the Eyes of Hashem that up above the enemy is good but down here the enemy is evil so by adopting the attitude of being above the enemy we can be sure to be triumphant. כב As a result: Of contemplating the enemy’s background and root one will soon become less intimidated by that enemy. יד Take captives: Which as explained above does not apply to the battle for Eretz Yisroel because no soul shall be allowed to remain alive there,

which automatically means no captives as mentioned earlier. Basic translation: Of the word
Reish Lokish says in Talmud Gittin

the Possuk of “

כִּי תֵצֵא לְמִלְחָמָה

If you go out to war upon your enemies”

to only mean ‘If’ you will go to battle, and not ‘when’ you will go to battle, because by definition the word ‘if’ can only be talking about an optional battle. So, our question returns: How is this consistent with the Alter Rebbe’s explanation, that this Possuk refers to the spiritual battle of the Avoda of prayer, considering that the battle of prayer is not an optional battle, but is an obligatory battle? And, even more so it is particularly an important obligation (even more of an obligation than the performance of Mitzvos)! (90a) that the term Ki actually has at least four distinct meanings: If, perhaps, rather, and because. However, two very widespread meanings are missing from this saying: ‘when’ and ‘that’. Scholars have tended to claim that these meanings are hinted at by one of the four words, e.g., the meaning ‘when’ is covered by ‘if’. In our context the words

כִּי תֵצֵא לְמִלְחָמָה

can either mean “If you go out to war”

or it can mean “when you go out to war”. How is this: Pirush Rashi that we are referring here to an optional war. Battle of prayer: Which is an obligated battle against the Yetzer HoRa who comes with all sorts of desires and distractions at the time when one is immersed in prayer. The performance of Mitzvos: Which each Mitzvah is important in

As is understood from the Alter Rebbe’s description of prayer: ‘That every person sacrifices his own animal soul to elevate it and to connect it back to its root’. The root of the animal soul also stems from the supernal element of fire, which is its source from where it was hewn and founded. This is in the holy spiritual mountains of the face of the lion and the face of the ox of HaShem’s supernal chariot. It is only after the descent of the animal soul through the Seder Hishtalshelus and through the seventy its own unique special way, but here we are referring to the war on the faculty of desire which is an arch enemy of a person’s want and need to serve HaShem. Which is a general and fundamental aspect about our connection with HaShem. Also stems: Not only does the Divine soul stem from holiness but the animal soul does too. Supernal chariot: And as mentioned earlier these are the holy spiritual source and root of everything animalistic in this world. Seder Hishtalshelus: The chain order of

descent and contraction of Hashem's infinite light and influence as it filters through levels and worlds in a gradual orderly fashion from one level down to the next level through the ten supernal Sefiros in each of the four groups of spiritual worlds thus transforming the light from an all-powerful infinite supernal divine light above

spiritual princes and by pervading the waste product of the supernal Ofanim Angels, that the worldly that is far too intense for any living thing to experience down to a contracted light that can then create, bring into being and then to vitalise the finite material world and all its inhabitants into existence. It is called a chain order because each level is intrinsically connected to the level above and to the level below. And the light that shines out at every level is very different to the light that shines out at other levels. Seventy spiritual princes: Through which the seventy Nations of the world receive sustenance. Midrash Tanchuma, cited in Seder Hadoros States: When Avrohom was 48 years old, in the year 1996 (1765 BCE), HaShem gazed upon the great tower that was still under construction. Turning to the seventy angels that surround His throne, He said, "They are one people, and they all have one language... Let us go down there, and confound their language, that they will become seventy nations with seventy languages." (Bereishis 11:6/7). The Midrash then tells how G-d and the seventy angels cast lots to see which angel would be charged with which language and nation. When HaShem's lot was Avrohom, He proclaimed, "Portions have fallen to Me in pleasant places; even the lot pleases Me." (Tehillim 16:6) As Rabeinu Bachaya writes: (Bereishis 11:9) The descendants of Noach who had numbered seventy at that time, were now divided into seventy nations, each with a distinctive language. You know already that there are seventy "princes," i.e. representatives in the celestial spheres who represent these seventy nations before the throne of G'd. They correspond to the respective kings or heads of these nations here on earth. Waste product of the Ofanim: Implied is that what is rejected as waste by the higher level serves as a source of energy for the lower level. An excerpt from the Sefer Eitz Chayim (Shaar Kitzur Abia 50:9) "what is the concept of the Yetzer Tov and the Yetzer HoRa because it is very deep and according to my humble opinion the truth is known that all the worlds are good and bad and in the world of Asiyah the bad is the four elements which are the waste product of the Ofanim angels and they enter a person as the Possuk states (Bereishis 4:7) "at the entrance, sin is lying", the substance which is the body and the form which is souls of the elements" Ofanim: Are angels. The word Ofanim has a connotation of wheels or rotations like the modern Hebrew word for bicycle אופניים. The esoteric meaning of the name Ofanim refers to the angels in the spiritual world of Asiyah they are called Ofanim because of the connotation of a wheel. For the

pleasures and the faculty of desire stoop down below. The worldly pleasures and the faculty of desire remain however in the category of the heat of fire. ¹⁷As well as the Yetzer HoRa which is also a burning foreign fire. One's objective therefore, is to elevate the animal soul back up to its source which is the state of fire above. The Alter Rebbe continues to explain that every day a person's inclination dominates him afresh ¹⁸and he has angels in that spiritual world desire and "roll" to become joined to on high. ¹⁹Heat of fire: In the spiritual spheres there is a source for each of the four spiritual elements: Fire, Water, Wind and earth. Everything in this

world is made up of varying quantities of the four spiritual elements and the physical manifestation of the combination of those spiritual elements expresses itself in a revealed sense thus we can sometimes discern when there is an unbalanced ratio of the four spiritual elements. i.e. in our drinking water there is a high concentration of the spiritual element of water although there are also other elements thus we see the build up of scale inside a kettle which is from the earth element within the water. Passion and desire among other traits are sourced primarily in the spiritual element source of fire. 17A fresh: And even if yesterday one succeeded in overpowering one's evil inclination the next day their evil inclination is back in full force and needs to be subdued once again. Although there are ways of getting rid of one's evil inclination as the Alter Rebbe quotes Dovid Hamelech who describes his hollow void to which our Sages tell us that Dovid Hamelech killed his evil inclination through fasting, this is a long and difficult journey and not expected of everyone, but what is expected that each and every one of us can control and subdue our evil inclination and through continuously controlling and subduing he will remain at bay.

to draw down 17 from the supernal state of fire above to subdue it. 17 As the Possuk 17 states “

ימים יצרו

Days have been formed”

that a person is allotted a predetermined fixed number of days 17 as the Possuk 17 states

ימי שנו תינו ב הם “ ש ב עים ש נה גו

The span of our life is seventy years”.

. This allotted time is not given for the benefit of the Divine soul within him because the Divine soul does not need to be rectified. 17 This allotted time is given as the 17 Draw down: From up on high. 17 To subdue it: with the impetus from the fire above we can overcome our desires and passions for worldly material things. 17 Possuk: (Tehilim 139:16)

גל מי ראו עי נך ו על ס פ רך כ לם י כ תבו ימים י צרו “ ולו א חד ב הם

**Your eyes saw my unformed body, and on Your book they were all written;
days have been formed and one of them is His”**

Rashi states on the words: Days have been formed: In other words, Hakodosh Boruch Hu has created the world and created time and created days so that we can do our Avodah in this world as we were created to do. **מ**Number of days: In which he has to continuously subdue his evil inclination. **ב**Possuk: (Tehilim 90:10)

י מִי־שָׁנוּ תִּינוּ בָּהֶם שֶׁבַע עִשְׂרֵים וְנֹהוּ אִם בִּגְבוּרַת שְׁמוֹ נִים שֶׁנֶּהוּ רָה בָּם עַמְלֹו א
וֹן כִּי־גַזְחִישׁ “וְנַע פֶּה

The span of our life is seventy years, or, given the strength, eighty years; but the best of them are toil and pain, they pass by speedily and we fly away.

גNot to be rectified: The Divine soul is a part of HaShem Himself and cannot be contaminated and only comes down into this material

lifespan of a person for the benefit of one's animal soul that pervades him. The amount of time allotted to a person is the time that HaShem in His great wisdom blessed be He has assessed to be sufficient for one to be able to engage with one's soul **מ**so as to elevate all the energies and sparks **מ**that fell there in the breakup of the vessels (as is explained in many Chassidic discourses). **ו** world in order to grow through its achievements in rectifying refining and elevating the body and the animal soul. **מ**One's soul: One's animal soul. **מ**Sparks: The lofty Divine sparks that fell there within the animal soul from the breakup of the vessels from the previous world of Tohu. **ו**Many Chassidic discourses: It is explained in kabbalah and in Chassidus that our material world benefits from a Seder Hishtalshelus as described earlier in footnote 31 in which HaShem's creative and vitalising energy filters down from His infinite highs in an organised and control manner so as to contain and distribute the Divine light from level to level as it contracts to become concealed enough to be able to create and vitalise our finite world. However, prior to our world (Which in an environment without the concept of time means higher spiritually than our world) HaShem created a seemingly less organised world in which the Divine lights were far too many for the few vessels and HaShem allowed that world to collapse thus causing the breakup of the vessels which caused a mixture of good and bad when the sparks fell into areas that are not holy, which ultimately facilitated our world and perspective. Thus, our world is called the world of 'Tikkun' – rectification in which our mission is to gather to lofty sparks

Accordingly, it transpires that the battle of the Avodah of prayer is a primary aspect in serving HaShem. To the extent that it is the ultimate purpose for the descent of the Neshomah into the body **ו**which is analogous to the descent from a very high roof into a very deep pit. So how can we say that this Possuk is talking about an optional battle? **מ** GIMEL The truth is that we can still actually translate

to mean “If you go out to war upon your enemies”

as Rashi states that this Possuk refers to an of the world of Tohu that were to great to be contained in the vessels of the previous world and contain them in our vessels. מַמְּ Into the body: Which is a very steep descent. חֲמֵ An optional battle: So, our question becomes even stronger! How can the Alter Rebbe’s explanation that we are talking about a battle of prayer which is very much obligatory and a primary element in serving HaShem that incorporates what we have been discussing of subduing the evil inclination as is not only necessary but mandatory for every Jew, so how can we align this with Rashi’s statement that our Possuk

כִּי־ תֵצֵא לִמְלַחְמָה

is specifically talking about an optional battle and not an obligatory battle?

optional battle טֵחֵ and it can still align with the Alter Rebbe’s translation that it refers to the battle of the Avodah of prayer. Because although the Avodah of prayer is an obligatory battle for every single Jew, however, it is only the beginning of one’s Avodah. נֵאֵ Soon afterwards there are two options of Avodah: to immerse into the Avodah of Torah study or the Avodah of prayer. To explain: it has already been explained in several places that there are two paths to dealing with and טֵחֵ Optional battle: which means that you can go out to battle or you might not go out to battle. And if you do go to battle then there are associated laws that are discussed in the continuation of the Parsha. And even though the Avodah of prayer is a primary aspect in serving HaShem. Even here we can still say

כִּי־ תֵצֵא לִמְלַחְמָה

if you will go out to battle, as an optional battle, and

there can still be a chance that you don’t go out to battle. Avodah of prayer: Because although we have a mandatory obligation to deal with our evil inclination and subdue it however we have a choice how we carry out this task as will be explained. נֵאֵ Beginning of one’s Avodah: Once one has passed the first stage of serving HaShem and ascended to a higher level...

refining נֵבֵ one’s Yetzer HoRa - one’s evil inclination. Either through battle נֵבֵ or through peace. נֵבֵ These two paths generally mirror הֵבֵ the two paths in Avodah: The Avodah of prayer which (as explained earlier) is an Avodah of battle, וֵבֵ and the Avodah of Torah study which as the Possuk states:

Its ways are ways of pleasantness, and all its paths are peace”.

נ This is because the system in which the Avodah of prayer refines the Yetzer HoRa is from below to above. ט The method being that the refiner (the Divine נב Refining: Separating the good from the bad, rectifying it and elevating it back into holiness. נג Through battle: Fighting the Yetzer Hora and subduing it. נד Through Peace: Transforming it into good. נה Generally mirror: The differences between prayer and Torah study are similar to the differences between battle and peace. נו Avodah of battle: Dealing directly with the Yetzer HoRa. נז Are peace: Refining the yetzer HoRa through Torah study means that the Yetzer hoRa becomes refined on its own. נח Yetzer HoRa: The evil inclination. ט Below to above: It is a descent down to lift the Yetzer HoRa but then it is about elevating him from below to above.

soul) permeates the refined (the animal soul) and operates from within. Which is why it is a battle and requires a concerted effort. However, the refinement which the Avodah of Torah study achieves, operates from above to below. (As is known that the Torah is referred to as ‘bread from heaven’) טד. This refinement is a much smoother process and happens automatically, as a result of one’s Torah study he draws down and reveals G-dliness upon himself, as a result of ה which the Yetzer HoRa becomes Permeates: Which means that the permeator first descends to the permeated. and Battle: Because the permeation initially causes unrest and close combat with the Yetzer HoRa and the animal soul. וב Refinement: When studying Torah, the animal soul and evil inclination dissolve and self-refine in light of the Torah. ג Above to below: Torah is the wisdom of HaShem so even when it is down here below it is still above, and when down here in this world has an effect on that which is around it. טב Bread from heaven: Spiritual sustenance that descends and extends from above to below. ה Result of: This intense Divine light shining down upon him in a revealed sense.

nullified and refined on its own. י According to, it is understood why this system of refining one’s Yetzer HoRa י can be considered an optional battle. נ Because there are other options of refining the Yetzer HoRa in a relaxed manner ט as a result of Torah study. This is what is referred to at the end of our Parsha when the Torah writes:“

ו ה י ה ב ה נ י ח ה' א ל ק יך לך מ כ ל- א י ב יך ג ו' ע א

It will be, when HaShem your G-d grants you respite from all your enemies”

ב because then there will be no need י On its own: Without any need of the Yetzer Tov and Divine soul to first permeate him. י Refining one’s Yetzer HoRa: Through the battle of prayer. נ Considered an optional battle: Because although refining the Yetzer HoRa is mandatory, the system one engages is optional. ט Relaxed manner: Without combat or battle. Our parsha: Parshas Ki Seitzei. א Torah writes: (Devorim 25:19)

והיה בנהיח' אל קיך לך מכל-אי ביך מסביב ארץ אשר הי' אל קיך נתן
לך נחלה

לרשתה תמחה את-זכר

(זכר)

עמלק מתחת "השמים לא תשכח

It will be, when HaShem your G-d grants you respite from all your enemies around [you] in the land which HaShem your G-d, gives to you as an inheritance to possess, that you shall obliterate the remembrance of Amalek from beneath the heavens.

You shall not forget!" עב Respite from all your enemies: In other words, the Torah is discussing a situation in which Hakodosh Boruch Hu helps the B'nei Yisroel that they shall live in a relaxed

for any war. As the Possuk עג states: "

פדה בשלום נפשי מקרב-לי גו

He redeemed my soul in peace from the battle that came upon me,"

עד" and as it says: "

וחרב לא-תעבר בארצכם עה

And no sword will pass through your land"

not even עא a sword of peace עב and then the Avodah will be in a relaxed manner which is the way of the Avodah of Torah study. Furthermore, עב even when the situation calls for battle

environment amongst all their enemies around them. עגPossuk states: regarding the cessation of the rebellion and opposition to him from the people of Avsholom. (Tehillim 55:19)

פדה ב שלום נ פ שי מ ק רב לי כי ב ר בים היו ע מ די

“He redeemed my soul with peace from the battle that came upon me, because of the many [people who] were with me.”

עהAnd it says: (Vayikra 26:6)
עPeace ... upon me: Redemption and triumph in peace without any need for battle.

ו נ ת תי שלום ב א רץ ו ש כ ב תם ו אין מ ח ריד ו ה ש ב תי ח יה ר עה מן ה א רץ ו
ח רב לא ת ע בר ב א ר צ כם

“And I will grant peace in the Land,

and you will lie down with no-one to frighten you; I will remove wild beasts from the Land, and no sword will pass through your land”. עוNot even: Our Sages of blessed memory have told us this blessing means not even a sword of peace. עPeace: Not only will there not be any battle, there won't even be anything that resembles battle and reminds you of battle as in weapons, and you won't even need symbolic weapons to hold the peace. עהFurthermore: Another aspect which expresses this idea of serving HaShem in a relaxed manner as opposed to in a battle.

in the Avodah of prayer, עif partnered with Torah study which is an Avodah in a relaxed manner פthen the Avodah of prayer also becomes something else entirely. ב This is because in the same way that engaging in Torah after prayer is greater than engaging in Torah before prayer. Because of the effect that prayer has on Torah. פג So too, Torah study has an effect on prayer that the prayer becomes elevated thereby. עט פד Avodah of prayer: As mentioned earlier that in the beginning of one's Avodah one does need to focus on prayer. Torah study: Where one studies Torah in addition to his prayers. נפ Relaxed manner: Without the need for battle. כב Something else entirely: Even though the Avodah of prayer is associated with battle. פג Prayer has on Torah: Notwithstanding that these two Torah and prayer are two distinct forms of Avodah. Nevertheless, each one has an advantage on the other, and just as Torah study after prayer has an advantage due to the prayer before it, which is why it is superior to Torah study before prayers. דפ Elevated thereby: That because one has studied Torah before this

Daled We can connect the concepts discussed above regarding the two different methods of Avodah through prayer and through Torah with the ethos פה of the month of Elul.

Particularly, in view of the observation that in Likkutei Torah, already in Parshas Re'ay, **פר** the Alter Rebbe's Maamorim discuss the Avodah of the month of Elul; How much more so now **פר** in Parshas Ki-Seitzei. **פר** prayer the prayer is a greater prayer than a prayer that was not preceded by Torah study. The same way that the animal soul is easier to dominate through Torah after he has had a beating through Davening so too after the animal soul has been subdued through Torah he becomes easier to triumph through the battle of Tefilah. So we see from here how an optional battle and an obligatory battle are not a contradiction. **פר** Ethos: The unique Avodah of serving HaShem in the month of Elul. **פר** Parshas Re'ay: Which is sometimes Shabbos Mevorechim and sometimes Rosh Chodesh Elul. **פר** Now: Two Parshas on which is always well into the month of Elul. **פר** Ki Seitzei: We should be discussing the Avodah of the month of Elul. Specifically, as there is a Chassidish Vort that the month of Elul in time is as the cities of refuge are in space and therefore important to utilise our time in the month of Elul wisely.

The Possuk says:

אני לדודי ודודי לי פט

I am to my beloved, and my beloved is to me,”

(to which the name of the month Elul () **לול** is an acronym) and the Possuk continues: “

הרו עה בשושנים

who grazes among the roses”.

There are two explanations that are known for these words

הרו עה בשושנים

: the first is that a rose traditionally has thirteen petals.

This number corresponds to the ‘thirteen attributes of mercy’. This is very relevant **פט** Possuk says: (Shir HaShirim 6:3) “

אני לדודי ודודי לי הרו עה בשושנים

I am to my beloved, and my beloved is to me, who grazes among the roses”.

I the B'nei Yisroel am drawn and am coming closer to Hakodosh Boruch Hu and Hakodosh Boruch Hu is drawn and is coming closer to the B'nei Yisroel. Thirteen attributes of mercy: The Spiritual Cosmos is structured according to the pattern of the Ten Sefiros. The Thirteen Attributes of Mercy transcend this pattern and reveal an infinite outpouring of Divine goodness and mercy. This revelation cleanses all blemishes that may result from man's conduct and prevents the external forces of kelipah from deriving nurture from them. Similarly, this cleansing process removes any obstructions and barriers that prevent the person's inner G-dly potential from being expressed (Tanya, Iggeres HaTeshuvah, Epistle 8).] According to the Idra Raba (131b), Etz Chayim – Shaar Erech Anpin (Chp.11) See Likutei Sichot, (vol. 4, p.1348) The 13 Attributes of Mercy are as follows: 1. - mighty in compassion to give all creatures according to their need; 2. רחום merciful, that humankind may not be distressed; 3. חנון and gracious if humankind is already in distress; 4. ים א רך א slow to anger; (once, to the righteous) 5. ים א רך א slow to anger;

because in the month of Elul the 'thirteen attributes of mercy' are illuminated and revealed. אצ This concept צב is associated with the Avodah of prayer. According to the second explanation of these words don't read: שושנים meaning 'roses' but read: שושנים meaning 'who study' referring to those who study the Torah. צב (repeated again for the wicked) 6. חסד and plenteous in kindness; 7. אמת and truth; 8. צרכים keeping kindness. 9. אלפינו thousands; 10. שא עון forgiving iniquity; 11. פשע and transgression; 12. חטא and sin; 13. קנה and pardoning. There are many other opinions like in the Talmud Rosh Hashanah 17b, Tosfot, ad loc. Ramban, Rosh and Ibn Ezra.. אצ In the month of Elul... are revealed: The Maamor in Likkutei Torah states that Elul is a time when the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy are revealed. Although the Divine service of Elul is characterized by the verse: "I am to my Beloved," i.e., it is an arousal from below initiated by man, this arousal from below — particularly when it comes from someone who is distant from G-dliness — is evoked by an arousal and a generation of potential from Above, i.e., the revelation of the Thirteen Attributes of Mercy. The revelation of these Thirteen Attributes of Mercy is extended to every member of the Jewish people, even those most distant from HaShem. It generates potential from Above that enables the service of "I am to my Beloved" on the part of the Jewish people, whatever their spiritual standing. צב This concept: The revelation of the thirteen attributes of mercy. אצ Those who study Torah: So, both the Avodah of prayer which symbolises a refinement achieved by means of a battle as well as the Avodah of Torah study a refinement in a peaceful manner are both associated with the month of Elul.

We can add that regarding the revelation of the thirteen attributes of mercy themselves, אצ there is a big variation between the revelation of the thirteen attributes of mercy of the month of Elul compared with the revelation of the thirteen attributes of mercy of Yom Kippur. One of the differences is that the revelation of the thirteen attributes of mercy of Yom Kippur is primarily within the scope of "די לי" my beloved is to me" אצ which comes as a result of one's own efforts in his own Avodah of "

I am to my beloved”ו.צ Whereas the revelation of the thirteen attributes of

צדThemselves: The first explanation of the words

הרו עה בשו שנים

which is connected with the fact that the rose has thirteen petals.

צהMy beloved is to me: The revelation of G-dliness and HaShem coming near to the B'nei Yisroel from above to below. וצI am to my beloved: The person coming closer to Hakodosh Boruch Hu from below to above.

mercy of the month of Elul וצis about “אני לדודי” which comes to inspire one to exert an effort in his own Avodah of “

אני לדודי

I am to my beloved”.

צ This is the state of Isarussa Dil'Eilah וצthat comes from above to arouse the Isarussa Dil'Tatoh which is similar to the aspect of Torah that is from above to below like bread from heaven (As mentioned earlier). What this means is that the revelation of the thirteen attributes of mercy of the month of Elul which are וצMonth of Elul: An illumination from above to below. וצI am to my beloved: From below to above. וצIsarussa Dile'eilah: An arousal from above. A Divine inspiration from above. Where Hashem so to speak shines his countenance down upon the person drawing him in closer to Hashem. The general system is that when a person puts in the effort Hashem reciprocates by helping him along as the Talmud says (Yoma 38b): “If one comes to purify, they assist him”. Isarussa Dil'Tato: An inspiration from below. A self-motivated inspiration where a person inspires himself to become closer to Hashem and motivates himself to do more for his Yiddishkiet and his connection with Hashem. As a result of one's effort in his 'Isarussa Dil'tatoh' he will be rewarded with an 'Isarussa Dile'eilah.

associated with prayer are in a manner that is also associated with Torah. As a result, אקof which the prayer is on a higher level (As mentioned earlier in section Gimel). This is the advantage בקof the month of Elul over the rest of the year that its virtue is not just in prayer אקbut also in Torah study דקbecause of which one needs to increase דקin Torah study which is specifically a relaxed and peaceful Avodah. וקParticularly וקthrough the study of the

inner dimension of Torah the secrets and the ^א7As a result: Of the Torah study. ^ב7This is the advantage: And unique quality. ^ג7In prayer: The first explanation of the words of the Possuk

הרו עה בשו ש נים

.

the concept of the thirteen attributes of mercy. ^ד7Also, in Torah study: As in the second explanation of the words of the Possuk

הרו עה בשו ש נים

.

the concept of studying Torah. ^ה7Increase: In the month of Elul. ^ו7Peaceful Avodah: without any combat or battle at all. ^ז7Particularly: The concept of peace in Torah study is particularly connected with the study of the esoteric dimension of Torah.

secrets of the secrets of Torah where ^ח7there are no questions asked and no debates, ^ט7including as well the dissemination of the wellsprings of Chassidus ^י7to the outside world in an acceptable peaceful manner. And as a result of this one can truly affect the truth and the perfection of the concept of “

פ דה ב שלום

He redeemed my soul in peace”.

^{יא}7This will be the true and complete redemption that will happen through the coming of Moshiach our righteous one when the promise ^{יב}7of the future will come to fruition as the Possuk states:

מ ל אה קיג “ ה א רץ ד עה את־ה' כ מ ים ל ים מ כ סים

for the land shall be full of

חקWhere: In this area of Torah there are no debates... טקNo debates: Because peace and the lack of battle are so strongly emphasized that even in the words of Torah themselves there are no questions or debates. קיChassidus: The deeper, inner dimension of Torah. קיאIn peace: A true and complete redemption. קיבPromise: That Yeshayohu promised about the state of the world in the future times of Moshiach. קיגPossuk states: Yeshayohu 11:9)

לא- י רעו ולא- י ש חיתו ב כל- הר ק ד שי כ- מ ל אה " ה א רץ ד עה את-ה' כ מ
ים ל ים מ כ סים

They shall neither harm nor destroy on all My holy mount, for the land shall be full of knowledge of HaShem as water covers the sea bed".

לע"נ הרה"ח מו"ה ר' מרדכי צבי ז"ל בן ר' יוסף חיים ז"ל אלעזר חנניא יו"ט ליפא ז"ל

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מת מרת מלכה ע"ה

knowledge of HaShem as water covers the sea bed". קיד קידSeabed: That just as the water of the sea covers all of the seabed so too the knowledge of HaShem will cover and fill the whole world.